

✅ Multiple Ways to Create a New Dataflow in Power BI Service

In **Power BI Service**, a **dataflow** is used to **extract, transform, and load (ETL)** data from various sources into the Power BI cloud environment.

It helps centralize and reuse data transformations across multiple reports and datasets.

You can create a **new dataflow** in **multiple ways**, depending on your data source and workflow preferences.

Below are all the main methods explained 🙌

🔧 1 From a Workspace in Power BI Service

This is the **most common method**.

Steps:

1. Go to [Power BI Service](#).
2. Navigate to the **workspace** where you want to create the dataflow.
3. Click **“+ New” → “Dataflow”**.
4. Choose **“Add new tables”** or **“Link tables from other dataflows”**.
5. Select your **data source** (e.g., SQL Server, Excel, SharePoint, etc.).
6. Use the **Power Query Online editor** to clean and transform your data.
7. Click **Save & Close** and name your dataflow.

📦 **Result:** A new dataflow is created and stored in that workspace.

🔗 2 From Power BI Desktop (via Dataflow Connector)

You can **connect to an existing dataflow** or **create a new one** while preparing your dataset in Power BI Desktop.

Steps:

1. Open **Power BI Desktop**.
2. Go to **Home → Get Data → Power Platform → Power BI dataflows**.
3. You can connect to existing dataflows, or prepare transformations in Desktop and then **publish them as a new dataflow** in the Service.

💡 *Useful when you want to migrate Power Query transformations from Desktop to the cloud.*

🔗 3 From Existing Dataflow (Using Linked Tables)

You can reuse data that's already processed by another dataflow.

Steps:

1. Go to your **workspace → Dataflow section**.
2. Click **“New → Dataflow” → “Link tables from other dataflows.”**
3. Select the existing dataflow and choose which tables to reuse.
4. Optionally, perform additional transformations.

 **Benefit:** Reduces redundancy and improves data consistency across reports.

From a Template App or Sample Dataflow

Power BI provides **template dataflows** for common data models (e.g., Salesforce, Dynamics 365).

Steps:

1. In your workspace, click **“New → Dataflow”**.
2. Choose **“Start from a template”**.
3. Select a prebuilt template (like “Customer Retention” or “Sales Analytics”).
4. Connect your data source and modify as needed.

 **Benefit:** Saves time — ideal for beginners or standard data models.

Using Power Automate (Flow Integration)

You can **automate** dataflow creation or refresh through **Power Automate**.

Example Workflow:

- Trigger: File added to OneDrive or SharePoint.
- Action: “Refresh a dataflow” or “Create a dataflow” in Power BI.

 *Useful for automating refreshes and managing multiple dataflows.*

From Power BI REST API

Developers can create and manage dataflows programmatically using the **Power BI REST API**.

Example:

- Use POST /groups/{groupId}/dataflows endpoint to create a new dataflow JSON definition.

 *Useful for enterprise automation and large-scale deployments.*

Summary Table

Method	Where/How Created	Ideal For
From Workspace (Manual)	Power BI Service → Workspace → New → Dataflow	Most common, manual setup
From Power BI Desktop	Publish Power Query transformations	Migrating Desktop models to cloud
Linked Dataflows	Reuse tables from existing dataflows	Data consistency and reuse
Template Dataflows	Use prebuilt templates	Quick start for common scenarios
Power Automate	Automated workflows	Schedule or trigger dataflow creation

Method	Where/How Created	Ideal For
Power BI REST API	Programmatic creation	Automation & enterprise solutions

✅ In summary:

You can create new dataflows in Power BI Service through **workspace creation, Power BI Desktop, linked dataflows, templates, Power Automate, or REST API** — each serving different business and automation needs.